The deductions, credits, and filing strategies most family caregivers miss

Stop Leaving Caregiver Tax Money on the Table

If you help care for a family member, the tax code likely owes you more than you think. This guide shows you what to claim — in plain English.

> **Did you know?**
> The average family caregiver misses $3,000 – $8,000 in tax savings every single year. This guide helps you claim what is rightfully yours.

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Are You a Caregiver? (Quick Quiz)

Check every box that applies to you:

- ☐ Do you help a parent, spouse, or family member with daily activities?
- ☐ Do you pay for any of their medical bills?
- ☐ Do they live with you?
- ☐ Do you pay for their prescriptions?
- ☐ Have you taken time off work to care for them?
- ☐ Do you pay for their home care or adult day services?
- ☐ Are they claimed on your tax return?
- ☐ Do you pay for transportation to medical appointments?

Your Result

If you checked 3 or more boxes, you likely qualify for significant tax benefits. Keep reading.

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The 5 Biggest Deductions

1. **Medical Expense Deduction**
   You can deduct medical expenses that go over 7.5% of your income.

2. **Dependent Care Credit**
   Worth up to $3,000 for one dependent, or $6,000 for two.

3. **Head of Household Filing Status**
   Can save you $1,000 – $3,000 in taxes versus filing single.

4. **Medical Mileage Deduction**
   About 21 cents per mile for medical trips (2024 rate).

5. **Long-Term Care Insurance Deduction**
   Premiums are deductible up to IRS age-based limits.

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Each Deduction, Explained Simply

Medical Expense Deduction
What it is: A deduction for big medical bills. Who qualifies: Anyone whose medical costs top 7.5% of income. Save: Often hundreds to thousands of dollars.

Dependent Care Credit
What it is: A credit for care costs so you can work. Who qualifies: Caregivers paying for a dependent’s care. Save: Up to $3,000–$6,000.

Head of Household
What it is: A better filing status. Who qualifies: Unmarried caregivers supporting a dependent. Save: $1,000–$3,000.

Medical Mileage
What it is: Money back for driving to care. Example: If you drove 500 miles to medical appointments, that is $105 back in your pocket.

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3 Filing Mistakes Caregivers Make

Mistake 1
Not keeping receipts. Without records, you cannot prove your deductions. Start a simple folder or envelope today.

Mistake 2
Forgetting the mileage log. Every medical trip counts. A small notebook in your car pays for itself many times over.

Mistake 3
Not claiming your family member as a dependent when you qualify. This unlocks several credits at once.

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What To Do Right Now

1. **Start a receipt folder**
   Physical or digital — just keep them all in one place.
2. **Begin a mileage log**
   Note the date, destination, and miles for every medical trip.
3. **List who you support**
   Write down each family member you help and how.
4. **Talk to a tax preparer**
   Bring this guide and ask about every deduction listed.

Questions? We are happy to point you in the right direction.

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Important Disclaimer
Sentinel Enterprises LLC is not a tax advisor or fiduciary. This guide is for education only. Confirm all deductions with a licensed tax professional.

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